

# Consultation outcome

## Proposed Rosters for Switchboard Services, Logan Hospital

December 2024



## 1. About this document

This decision document provides an overview of the proposed roster for Switchboard Services, Logan Hospital, Corporate Services, Logan and Beaudesert Health Service (**LBHS**), Metro South Health (**MSH**).

This document summarises the consultation process undertaken with the affected employees, relevant unions and other key stakeholders. It outlines the decisions that have been made in accordance with government policy and relevant industrial obligations and reflects upon the feedback received and the influence this had on the final decision.

## 2. Consultation process

On the **14 November 2024** a consultation document and proposed roster for Switchboard Services, Logan Hospital was released for consultation. Affected staff, unions and stakeholders were invited to provide feedback by **8 December 2024**.

During this consultation process, all feedback was reasonably considered through a structured and transparent approach of collecting feedback through multiple channels, consideration of feedback and communication of the responses.

## 3. Summary of feedback and responses

A total of **nine (9)** submissions of feedback was received during the consultation period. The feedback themes and responses are provided in **Attachment One**.

## 4. Ballot results

In accordance with Clause 6.2 of the [Hospital and Health Service General Employees \(Queensland Health\) Award – State 2015](#), agreement between MSH and the union, or MSH and the majority of employees affected must occur prior to changes to a shift roster.

Agreement is defined as obtaining consent from the majority (50+1%) of affected employees, with all affected employees invited to cast their vote via an online Ballot Form.

**17** affected employees were invited to cast a vote, with a total of **17** votes received. The breakdown of votes are as follows:

**14** 'Yes' votes received  
**3** 'No' votes received

## 5. Decision

Following consideration of the feedback and **82%** of affected staff voting '**Yes**', the Director, Corporate Services, LBHS **approved** progressing with the proposed rosters, date effective **20 January 2025**.

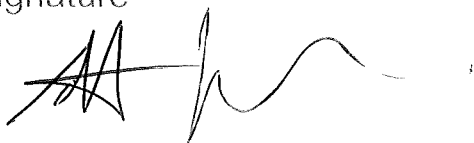
The proposed roster will be implemented on a trial basis for **six months**. On the conclusion of the trial period, affected staff will be invited to provide feedback on the effectiveness of the roster.

## 6. Supporting employees through change

LBHS recognises organisational change can be difficult for affected staff. Affected employees are offered the following ongoing support:

- Free and confidential support through the Employee Assistance Program. Information on the program and how to access it are available at:
  - [Metro South Employee Assistance Program \(EAP\)](#)  
Or by telephoning TELUS Health on 1800 604 640

7. Signature

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to be 'S. Hughes', written over a horizontal line.

**Mr Scott Hughes**

**Director**

**Corporate Services**

**Logan and Beaudesert Health Service**

12/12/24

| Feedback received                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Response                     |
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| Happy with this roster - [REDACTED]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Thank you for your feedback. |
| Hi it's [REDACTED] I am very happy with the new roster                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Thank you for your feedback. |
| I agree to trial this roster [REDACTED]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Thank you for your feedback. |
| I'm happy to trial proposed roster, the only way is work the roster and shifts.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Thank you for your feedback. |
| I appreciate your email and for the proposed roster. I am in agreeance with the proposal and happy for this to be allocated. Although I do have concerns that I wish to raise, even though the idea is for this to be a permanent roster. Specifically, I am concerned that staff members that have been allocated to fulfill all their nightshift obligations and subsequently request a reduction or provide a medical certificate for fewer nightshifts, it could disrupt the equilibrium of the roster. This situation may lead to a recurrence of past scenarios, where one half of the staff had their nightshift commitments reduced, while the other half had to bear significantly increased nightshift duties to compensate for the shortage. Such a scenario could pose challenges for those staff members who find themselves with additional nightshifts in place of afternoon or day shifts due to others being unable or unwilling to fulfill their nightshift responsibilities. Is there a plan or pathway in place for this situation if it occurs as it has in the past? Also in accordance to page 1 of the roster proposed, "The proposed roster will be trialled for a period of 6 months. At the conclusion of 6 months a review will be undertaken to evaluate the effectiveness." What parameters would be evaluated in the review to determine the effectiveness of the roster after the 6 months? Thank you for your attention to this matter | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- The effectiveness of the roster after the six-month trial period will be based on staff feedback/staff satisfaction survey.</li><li>- In the event a staff member is unable to work nights due to a medical condition, this will be managed confidentially between the affected employee, Switchboard Manager and in consultation with the LBHS Injury Management and Human Resources teams in accordance with the provisions of the relevant legislation, industrial instruments, and Queensland Health HR Policies.</li><li>- All shifts that require coverage will be managed by the Switchboard Manager in accordance with <a href="#">MSH Best Practice Rostering Guideline</a>. Team members are able to speak to their colleagues and request a shift swap with sufficient notice to the Switchboard Manager.</li></ul> |                              |

*I would like to raise a concern regarding the distribution of night shifts among the .07 lines. I feel that these shifts should be allocated more equitably. Currently, one staff member is assigned as many as 9 night shifts, while others are only allocated 2 or 3. This disparity feels unfair and could be addressed by balancing the shifts more evenly among the team.*

Thank you for your feedback.

- The 0.7fte (new) line was implemented as part of this proposed roster and consists mostly of nightshifts. At the time the temporary incumbent was converted from temporary to permanent, there were no vacancies within Switchboard Services. The affected employee was offered this line and accepted the terms and conditions of the role (primarily night shifts).
- This line was created to eliminate the need for the fulltime/part time staff to work more than four nights per month.

*After looking at the proposed roster as a full time employee I have noted that the full time members have lost seven weekend penalty shifts over a seven month period as you probably already know historically full time team members have always had three weekends a month and can be shown on all previous rosters. We are being asked to take a significant pay cut and I would like to know if this is even a legal request. As full time employees we are the last team members to be asked to do any overtime therefore it would be unlikely we would be able to recoup our loss of earnings and I'm also wondering if the people who have worked on this roster would be prepared to take a pay cut with their own employment ? I have also noted that we are being asked to now do four nights a month and as you can see from previous rosters we have been doing only three. A pay cut and an extra night it hardly seems fair or equitable or not I. The best interest of us as QLD Health employees, i have also noted that there are numerous weeks that full time staff only have one day of in that particular week. I don't feel that this roster has been done with the best interest of full time staff maintaining fatigue management. Kind regards*

Thank you for your feedback.

- This feedback was considered but unfortunately, we are unable to offer full-time staff three weekends per month due to the requirement to roster penalty shifts fairly and equitably across all FTE lines.
- We also have an obligation to consider wellbeing and fatigue, and to avoid a situation where we are asking full-time employees to work proportionally more weekends than other employees.
- Penalties have been allocated proportionate to FTE. Some minor modifications have been made to the full-time line in terms of weekend shifts. This is a rotational, cyclic roster; whilst one fortnight may have less penalties it is evened out over the duration of the four week roster cycle.

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| <p><i>I do not agree to having to take a pay cut, with this roster we are losing 7 penalties. We have lost 4 Saturday shifts and 3 Sunday shifts. With this roster you are forcing a pay cut. Is that legal? The current rostering system we got 3 weekends a month and 3 night shifts. The current rostering system works if done fairly. Which one of you would take a pay cut? We have been doing 3 nights a month for months now this roster goes to 4 nights and less money. Is the union involved with this roster? Isn't this for permanent staff casual staff don't get to agree to this. Why can't we submit an email where we can read what we have written? It seems that we have a lot of late starts there was a survey done where all staff preferred the same start time which was at the early times. 6am 1400 pm 22.00 pm. Don't say we can swap shifts that is not as easily done. There are weeks where we have only one day off how is that fatigue management? How is my pay going to be boosted when we are the last ones to get any overtime? Please don't lie to us if you force us to trial this wage theft you have no intentions of changing it or stopping it. Can we speak to the union representatives about the loss of income for starters. The current rostering system could work if favouritism wasn't a factor and used to bully people.</i></p> | <p>Thank you for your feedback.</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Together Queensland were invited to provide feedback as part of this consultation and ballot process.</li> <li>- The proposed roster has been developed after many years of consultation and feedback from previous rejected rosters and in accordance with the provisions of <a href="#">Hospital and Health Service General Employees (Queensland Health) Award – State 2015</a> and the MSH Best Practice Rostering Guideline.</li> <li>- Start times and shift cross overs are in place to support effective shift handover and to mitigate against inadequate coverage, should a staff member be delayed in commencing their rostered shift due to unforeseen circumstances (traffic etc.). This also aligns with other MSH Switchboard Services who roster a variety of shifts to cover all hours</li> <li>- Clause 15.1(j) provides the basis on which rostered days off have been considered for this proposed roster: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>(j) <i>Rostered days off - where work is performed on other than a Monday to Friday basis</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>(i) <i>Unless prescribed elsewhere in this Award, all employees shall be entitled to not less than two whole consecutive rostered days off duty each week.</i></li> <li>(ii) <i>In lieu of two whole rostered days off in each week, an employee may be allowed in each fortnightly period either one rostered day off in one week and three consecutive rostered days off in the other week, four consecutive rostered days off or two groups of two consecutive rostered days off.</i></li> </ul> </li> <li>(k) <i>Two consecutive rostered days off, one at the end of one week and one at the beginning of the following week may be counted as meeting the requirements of clause 15.1(j)(i).</i></li> </ul> </li> </ul> |
| <p><i>Loss of wages with this roster so unfair. You all take a pay cut as well.</i></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | <p>Thank you for your feedback.</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- The proposed roster has been developed to support fair and equitable rostering and remuneration across all affected staff, proportionate to FTE.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

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- Further, we also have an obligation to consider wellbeing and fatigue, and to avoid a situation where we are asking full-time employees to work proportionally more weekends than other employees.
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